

# CS 3130 Spring 2023

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This is a website for a prior offering of CS 3130.

## Changelog:

- 18 Jan 2023: make percentages add up to 100%
- 26 Jan 2023: explain more clearly how late policy applies to labs (late submission allowed, late checkoff not allowed without extenuating circumstances), matching what was explained in lecture.

## 1 Logistics

### 1.1 Meetings

Lecture is optional but strongly encouraged.

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Lectures are Tuesdays and Thursdays at 2pm. I will attempt to record all lectures.

I do not schedule review sessions or the like outside of usual class time.

### 1.2 Tasks

You will be asked to

- Participate in lab
  - Each lab has milestones that need to be reached for full credit.
  - For most labs, we will allow either submission via the submission site *or* in-person lab check-off with a TA. When labs are checked off in-person, we will be less strict about checking for completion/correctness since the TA will know more about how much time you spent on the lab.

- Some labs must be completed during the lab time and checked off with a TA, primarily for logistical reasons.
- If you have a reason you cannot attend lab (illness, etc.), please let me know about your situation and we'll make some accommodation.
- Do homework
  - Each homework is an individual assignment unless otherwise announced.
  - Some homework will be programming assignments; others will be puzzles, worksheets, or other kinds of activities.
- Take quizzes
  - We will have weekly quizzes, administered online. Quizzes are open-book, open-notes, and untimed. They are to be completed individually.
- Take a final
  - I expect to have an in-person final exam during our official scheduled exam time.

## 1.3 Readings

Although we have several textbooks we are considering for use, none of them were settled on for this pilot. Readings written by us or selected from articles or web pages will periodically be posted on the schedule.

## 1.4 Coding

*“If you really want to understand something, the best way is to try and explain it to someone else. That forces you to sort it out in your own mind. And the more slow and dim-witted your pupil, the more you have to break things down into more and more simple ideas. And that’s really the essence of programming. By the time you’ve sorted out a complicated idea into little steps that even a stupid machine can deal with, you’ve certainly learned something about it yourself.”*

—Douglas Adams

This course will involve multiple programming assignments in C (and maybe a bit of other languages).

Estimating how long it will take someone to complete a coding assignment is always difficult. The target difficulty is 5–10 hours of focused effort each week.

# 2 Grading

## 2.1 Points per Activity Type

Since this course has not been offered before, we may adjust these weights as the semester progresses. Any such adjustment will be discussed in class before being implemented.

| Task    | Weight | Comments          |
|---------|--------|-------------------|
| Quizzes | 30%    | Drop lowest score |
| Labs    | 15%    |                   |

| Task      | Weight | Comments |
|-----------|--------|----------|
| Homeworks | 40%    |          |
| Final     | 15%    |          |

Your final grade is computed based on the percentage of points you have earned and then converted to a letter grade. At the end of the semester, I will decide on a mapping from points to letter grades based on the actual difficulty of homeworks, exams, etc. This mapping will give at least a D- for a 60%, at least a C- for a 70%, at least a B- for an 80%, and at least a A- for a 90%.

## 2.2 Submitting late

Quiz solutions are released the moment the quiz closes, and thus quizzes cannot be taken late. Your lowest quiz score is dropped.

Homeworks and labs that allow submission may be submitted up to 72 hours late. (Labs may not be checked off late without special-case permission.) They are given 90% credit between 0 and 48 hours late; at 80% credit between 48 and 72 hours late. If extensions beyond that time are needed, please see the professor to discuss why and if other accommodations are also needed.

The final may not be taken late (or early) without special-case permission.

## 3 Miscellanea

### 3.1 Professionalism

Behave professionally.

Never abuse anyone, including the emotional abuse of blaming others for your mistakes. Kindness is more important than correctness.

Let our TAs be students when they are not being TAs.

### 3.2 Honesty

I always hope everyone will behave honestly. I know we all are tempted to do what we ought not; if you do something you regret, the sooner you tell me the sooner (and more leniently) we can correct it.

#### 3.2.1 No plagiarism (nor anything like it)

You **must** cite any and every source you consult, other than those explicitly provided by the course itself. Talked to a friend, saw an interesting video, consulted a website, had a tutor? Tell us! Put it in a comment in your code.

#### 3.2.2 Write your own code

You must write your own code. Not just type it (though you need to do that too): **compose**

**it yourself**, as your own original work. Beware of looking at other students code or code you find online: it is hard to unsee and can spoil your ability to compose your own solutions!

### 3.2.3 Understand what you submit

Working together can help you learn. But make sure you learned! We may ask you to explain aspects of a solution you turn in, and may dock points if it appears you simply copied someone else's ideas (or just guessed a lot of things until one worked) without understanding them.

### 3.2.4 No help on quizzes

It would probably go without saying if we didn't say it, but no assistance may be given or received on any supervised evaluation or online quiz unless specifically announced otherwise by the professor (or another proctor of the evaluation).

Quizzes (unless otherwise specified) are open book/open notes. You may ask for help with reviewing related lecture or lab material, but not specifically about the quiz questions.

### 3.2.5 Consequences of Dishonesty

If I believe you have acted dishonestly, I will communicate this fact to you and propose a penalty. If you have information I lack, please share that with me; I may thereafter change my belief and/or proposed penalty.

If we are not able to come to an agreement, or if the case is particularly egregious and beyond my comfort level handling in-course, we will instead refer the case to the University Honor System and abide by their findings.

## 3.3 Personal accommodations

If you believe that circumstances (illness, religious observations, family emergency, etc.) warrant an change in deadline or some other adjustment, please let me know and we'll figure out what we can do to accommodate your situation.

If you anticipate issues related to this course due to a disability, you also may want to work with the [Student Disability Access Center](#).

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CS 3130 Spring 2023

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